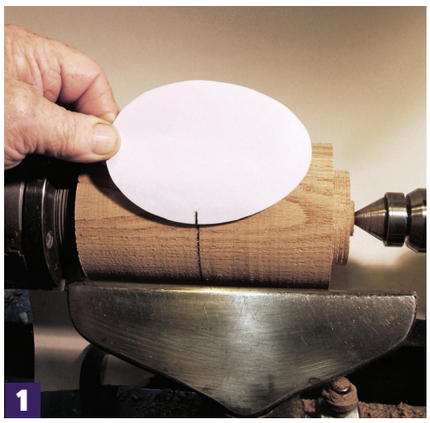

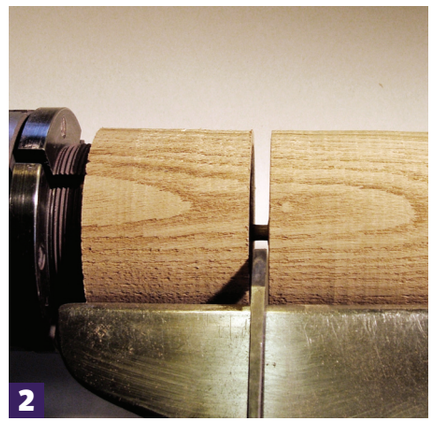

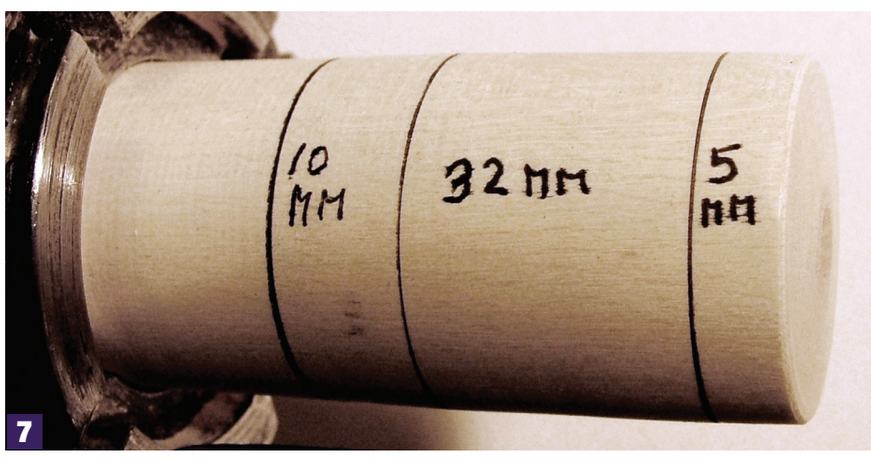

1 Start with a pre-turned cylinder of wood held in 50mm 'C' gripper jaws supported with the tail stock. I have used oak for this project. Turn a 50mm spigot on the other end. A card template of an egg profile is helpful in deciding where the blank should be parted in two and general shaping

2 Take care in parting off, making sure that space is left either side of the cut to avoid 'pinching'. Stop the cut at a safe thickness. Remove from lathe and snap/saw off

3 With the top section blank removed, the internal dimensions of the base can be completed using a 3mm parting tool, a 10mm fingernail profile spindle gouge and a 13mm box scraper, in that order. The intention is that the solid section in the base will enable the egg to wobble when stood upright

4 With an 18mm Forstner-type bit held in the tailstock, bore a 10mm deep hole in the centre. When this is completed, turn, sand and part off the egg bottom

5 Now attach the top half as before in the gripper jaws. Firstly turn a small flange on the outside rim edge, until a good push fit is achieved with the completed base

6 Hollow the interior, starting with a long-grind profile 10mm spindle gouge. Follow this with a heavier long-grind gouge allowing the inside to be shaped. These tools should not be used with the flute in the vertical position; I used them with the flute at about 9 o'clock in pull-cut mode. The final clean finish was achieved with my homemade round nose scraper, making a 'light and sheer cut'. Shape the exterior in the same manner as the base

7 Now shape the bunny body, firstly roughing out to 32mm diameter. I chose to use holly (*Ilex* spp.), held firmly in my extended O'Donnell jaws

HANDY HINTS

1. This project can be made to any scale. You are limited only by your imagination
2. If turned as a completely hollow egg box (without the bunny) one could create a Russian style nest of boxes, each decorated differently
3. It might be a good idea to turn a couple of solid eggs to practise getting the form correct; these eggs would make good presents in their own right or act as practice pieces for decorating
4. Although one can turn the thin stems for the flowers, I have used cocktail sticks; they are perfect and save time if a quantity is required

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